

Helene Olsen Kalstad

PERSONAL DATA

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PROFILE

PhD candidate in Economics with strong quantitative and applied macroeconomic training, specialised in time-series analysis, forecasting, and empirical analysis of global shocks. Experienced in translating complex economic models into decision-relevant insights. Seeking roles where rigorous data analysis supports strategic and operational decision-making.

EDUCATION

CURRENT AUG. 2022	PhD in ECONOMICS (expected completion: December 2026) BI Norwegian Business School , Oslo SUPERVISOR: Professor Hilde C. Bjørnland (BI Norwegian Business School) CO-SUPERVISOR: Dr. Knut Are Aastveit (Deputy Director Norges Bank Research)
NOV. 2021 AUG. 2020	Master of Philosophy in ECONOMICS Bocconi University , Milan
JUN. 2019 AUG. 2017	Master of Science (with Honours) in BUSINESS Majoring in ECONOMICS BI Norwegian Business School - GPA: 4.875/5.000 ELECTIVES: Game Theory, Behavioral Economics, Introduction to Asset Prices, Data Analysis in Python, and Energy in Green Transition. MASTER THESIS: <i>The Impact of Monetary Policy on Leading Variables for Financial Stability in Norway</i>
JUN. 2017 AUG. 2014	Bachelor of Science in BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS, BI Norwegian Business School - GPA: 4.583/5.000

WORK EXPERIENCE

JAN. 2022 JUN. 2018	Research Assistant at BI Norwegian Business School , Oslo <i>Centre for Applied Macroeconomics and Commodity Prices (CAMP)</i> <i>Professor Hilde C. Bjørnland and Professor Leif Anders Thorsrud</i> Research support and empirical analysis on macroeconomic and commodity-price dynamics, including VAR-based modelling and data construction.
JUL. 2022 JAN. 2022	Research Assistant at Norges Bank , Oslo <i>Research Department, Full time</i> Empirical analysis of macroeconomic and financial data, including time-series modelling, forecasting, and construction of financial indicators used in internal analysis.
AUG. 2020 AUG. 2019	Junior Researcher at Norges Bank , Oslo <i>Research Department, Full time</i>
DEC. 2018 AUG. 2018	Research Assistant at BI Norwegian Business School , Oslo <i>Centre for Monetary Economics (CME)</i> <i>Professor Tommy Sveen</i>
JUN. 2018 JAN. 2018	Research Assistant at BI Norwegian Business School , Oslo <i>Professor Jon H. Fiva</i>

WORK IN PROGRESS

Generative AI, Productivity, and Employment: Evidence from Two Labor Markets.

Description: Compares industry-level effects of generative AI in the US and Norway, finding that AI-exposed industries generate comparable value added in both countries but adjust through different margins: productivity gains in the US versus employment expansion in Norway. In neither country do workers capture the surplus through higher wages.

Is the Exchange Rate a Shock Absorber, or a Source of Instability? Iceland versus Sweden (with Hilde C. Bjørnland).

Description: Examines whether a floating exchange rate stabilises or destabilises a small open economy.

FDI, exchange rates and global shocks in commodity-exporting economies (with Hilde C. Bjørnland, Kjetil Martinussen and Francesco Ravazzolo).

Description: Empirical analysis using mixed-frequency macro and financial data to quantify how foreign investment and global shocks affect exchange rates and financial conditions. Combines local projections and VAR-based methods with relevance for risk assessment and international investment analysis.

PUBLICATIONS

Unveiling inflation: Oil shocks, supply chain pressures, and expectations (with Knut Are Aastveit, Hilde C. Bjørnland and Jamie L. Cross), *European Economic Review*, Vol. 181, 2026. [Link to article](#).

Earlier version: [Norges Bank Working Paper 12/2024](#).

Summary: Using a Bayesian structural VAR for six advanced, inflation-targeting economies, we show that global oil and supply chain shocks were major drivers of the post-pandemic inflation surge, and that inflation expectations amplified these effects in several countries.

A high-frequency financial conditions index for Norway (with Frida Bowe, Karsten R. Gerdrup and Nicolò Maffei-Faccioli), Norges Bank Staff Memo 1/2023.

Summary: Constructs a daily financial conditions index combining market prices and spreads to track short-run changes in Norwegian financial tightness and its co-movement with macro indicators.

The impact of monetary policy on leading variables for financial stability in Norway (with Harald Wieslander), CAMP Working Paper Series 02/2020.

Summary: Assesses how monetary policy shocks affect forward-looking financial stability indicators in Norway, documenting heterogeneous and state-dependent responses across variables.

AREAS OF INTEREST

Applied macroeconomics, international economics, time-series analysis, forecasting, and data-driven decision-making. Interests include productivity, business cycles, financial conditions, and the interaction between global shocks and firm- and market-level outcomes.

LANGUAGES

NATIVE PROFICIENCY:	Norwegian
FULL PROFESSIONAL PROFICIENCY:	English
INDEPENDENT USER:	Spanish

TECHNICAL SKILLS

DATA ANALYSIS:	MATLAB, Python, Stata
ECONOMETRIC MODELLING:	VARs, local projections, mixed-frequency models, forecasting
TIME-SERIES ANALYSIS:	Macroeconomic and financial data, shock identification
REPORTING AND VISUALISATION:	L ^A T _E X, MATLAB